



清华大学
Tsinghua University

General Management 2026 Spring

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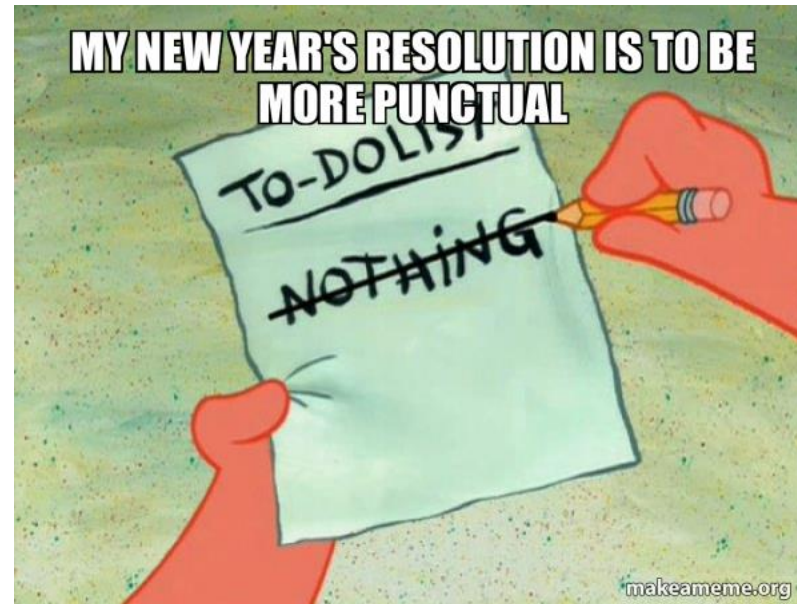
Temporal Landmark



How many of you make “new year resolution”?

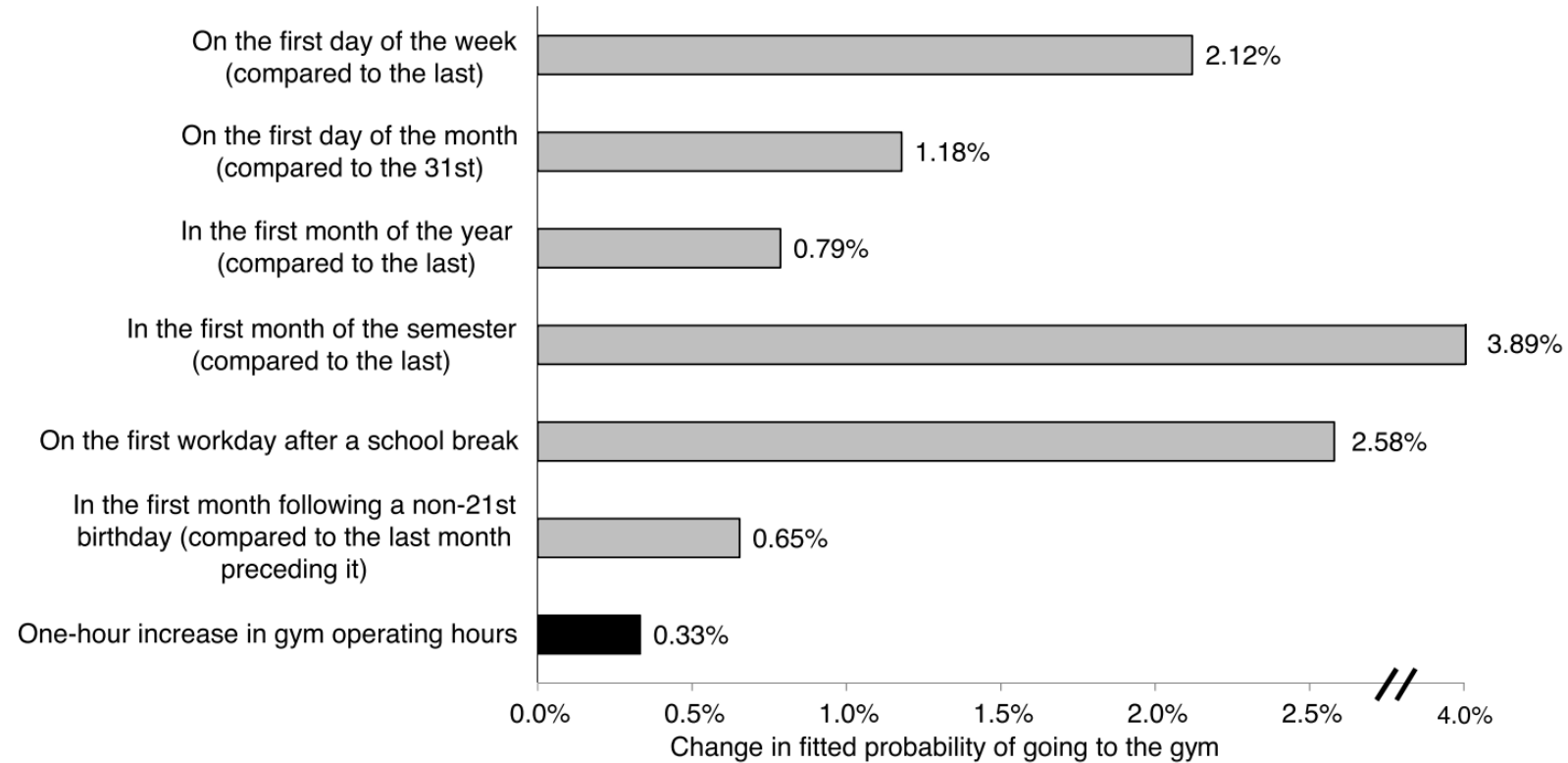
Temporal Landmark

- **Temporal landmarks:** Special dates that stand out and demarcate a new time period (e.g., birthdays, new year, new semester).





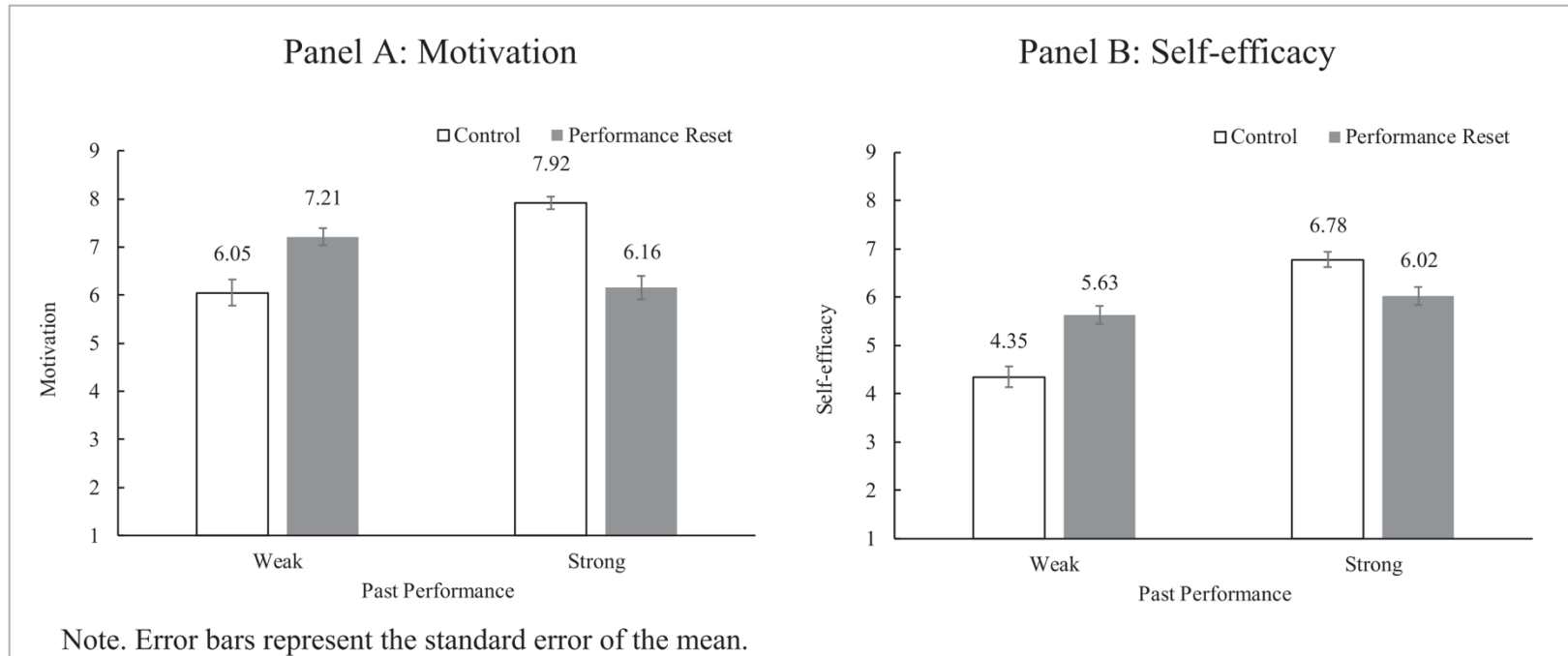
#1: “Fresh Start”



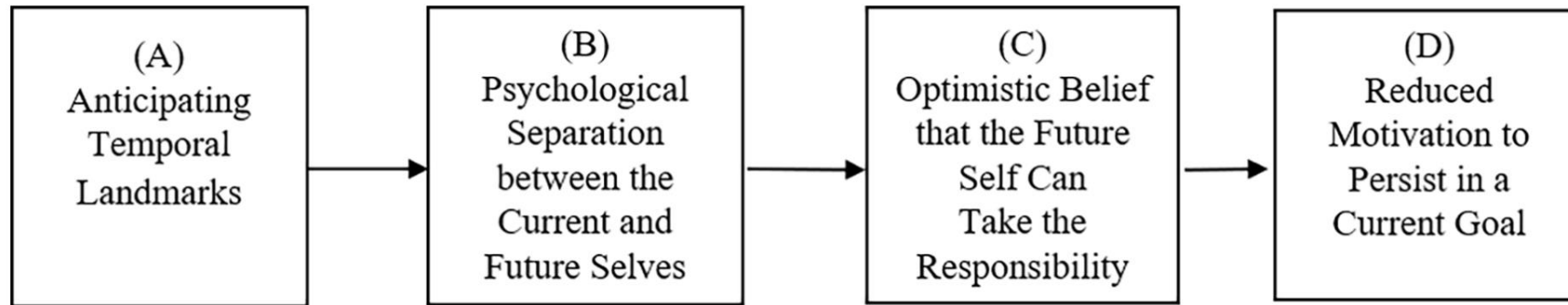
Fresh start can boost goal initiation!

#1: “Fresh Start”

- This temporal landmark separates current self from the “imperfect” past self
- “Put your imperfections behind you”



Be Careful with Loafing



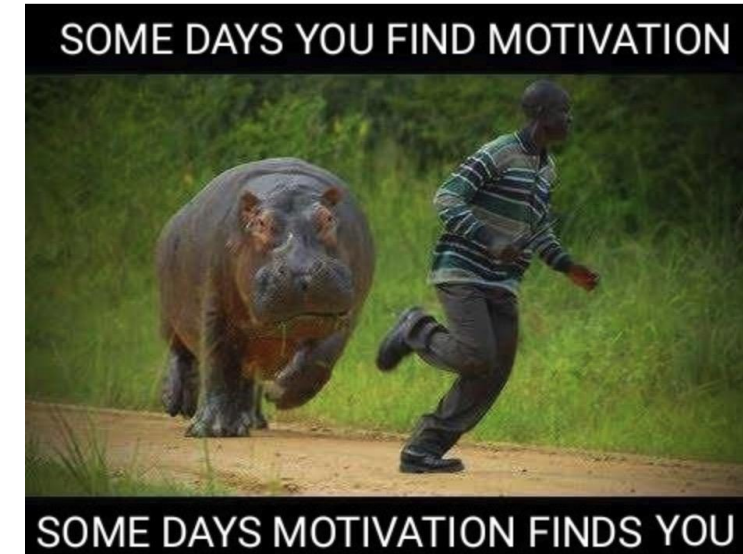
People shift responsibility to their future self and optimistically believe they'll try harder after the landmark

#2: Watch for Temporal Excuses

- “I’ll start fresh next Monday”
- “After the move, I will get back on track”



- “What’s one thing you can do today?”
- “Let’s not lose momentum”





#3: Daily Habits Over New Beginnings

- Help others:
 - Focus on **small, recurring actions**
 - Create **rituals** that tie to goals
- Tip: Remind them of things they already do that align with the goal (e.g., “You already walk daily — let’s tie that to your health target.”)

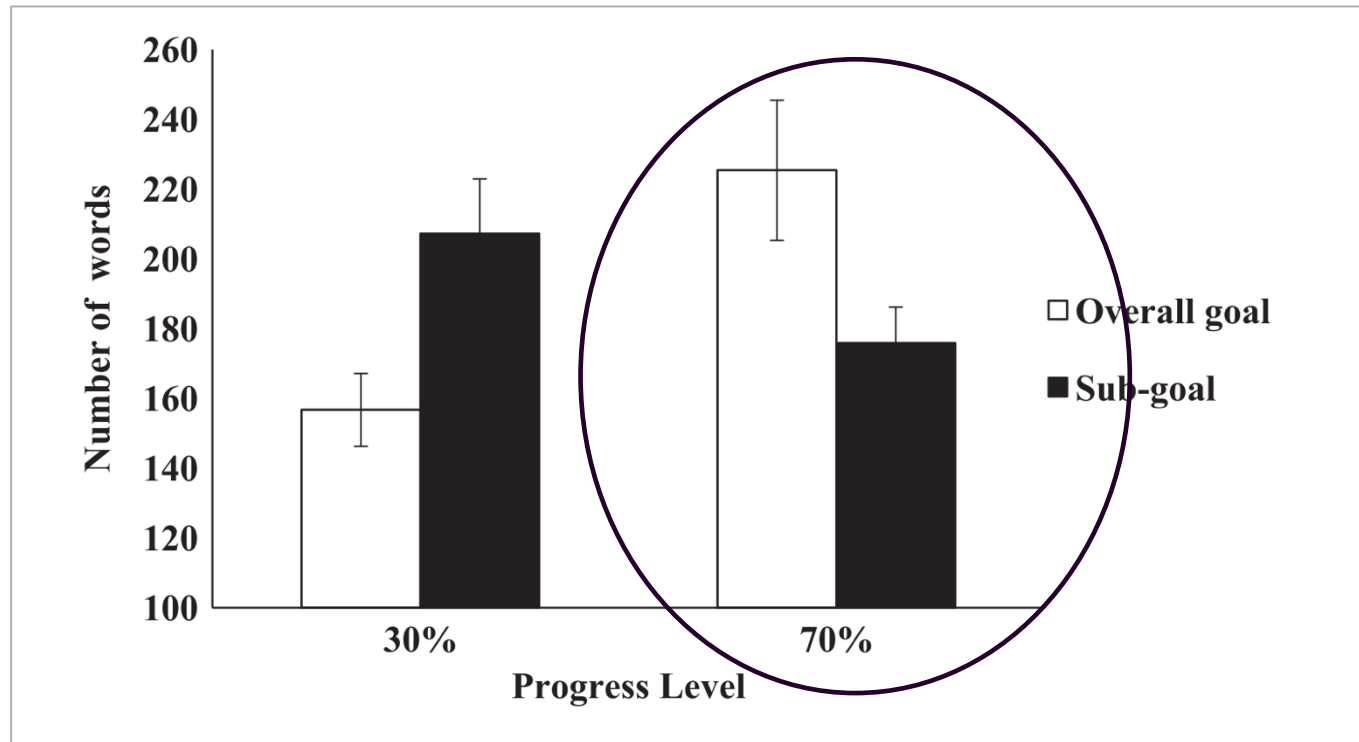
Temporal landmarks boost initiation, but consistent behavior sustains goals



#4: Sub-Goals

- Break overwhelming goals into bite-sized chunks
 - Boost perceived attainability
 - Each small win provides positive reinforcement

#4: Sub-Goals



Break big goals into smaller steps when people are just starting.
Shift focus back to the big picture near the end.



#5: The Best is Yet to Come

- Many people believe their life will get better in the future.
- But how they think about that better future matters!
 - **Reflective Thinking:** Future feels like an extension of the present
 - **Evaluative Thinking:** Future feels very different from the present



#5: The Best is Yet to Come

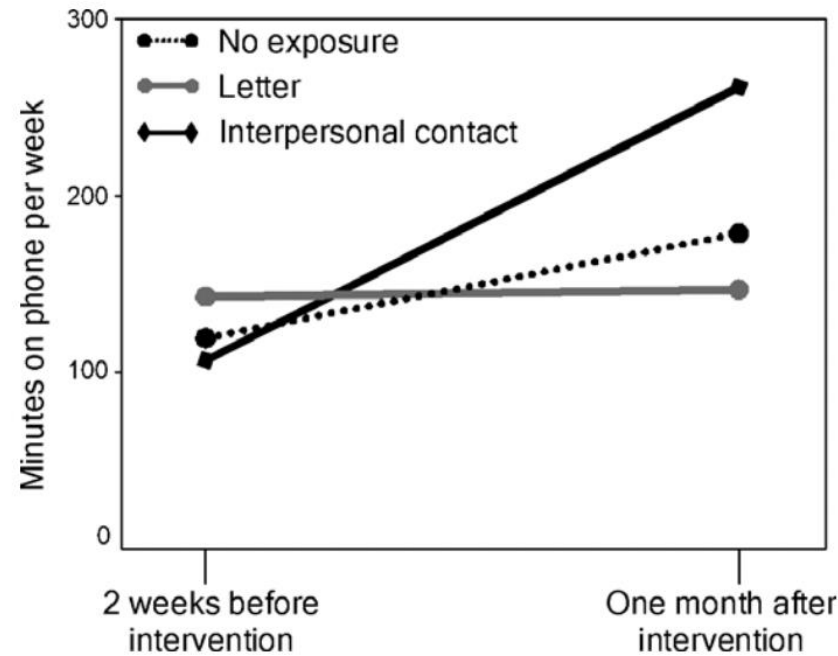
- If someone feels **hopeless**, help them **reflectively** see their growth:
 - “You’re already on that path. Let’s build on your momentum.”
- If someone is **fantasizing**, nudge an **evaluative** stance:
 - “What’s the gap between now and then? Let’s plan how to close it.”



#6: The Impact of Meaning

- People are more motivated when they see how their work impacts others.
- Call center employees met a scholarship student who benefited from their fundraising.

#6: The Impact of Meaning



+142% more time on the phone
+171% more money raised
Effects lasted over a month!

Fig. 1. Experiment 1 caller persistence pre- and post-intervention.

See who you're helping" → fuels motivation.



Who Needs Most Money

Researchers provide participants with a piece of paper filled with random letters, and asked them to find pairs of identical letters

- Condition 1: People in the first group wrote their names on their sheets and handed them to the experimenter, who looked it over and said “Uh huh” before putting it in a pile.
- Condition 2: People in the second group didn't write down their names, and the experimenter put their sheets in a pile without looking at them.
- Condition 3: People in the third group had their work shredded immediately upon completion

The less appreciated we feel our work is, the more money we want to do it

Interpersonal View of Motivation



INTERVIEW QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS

How to Answer “Why Are You Applying for This Position?”

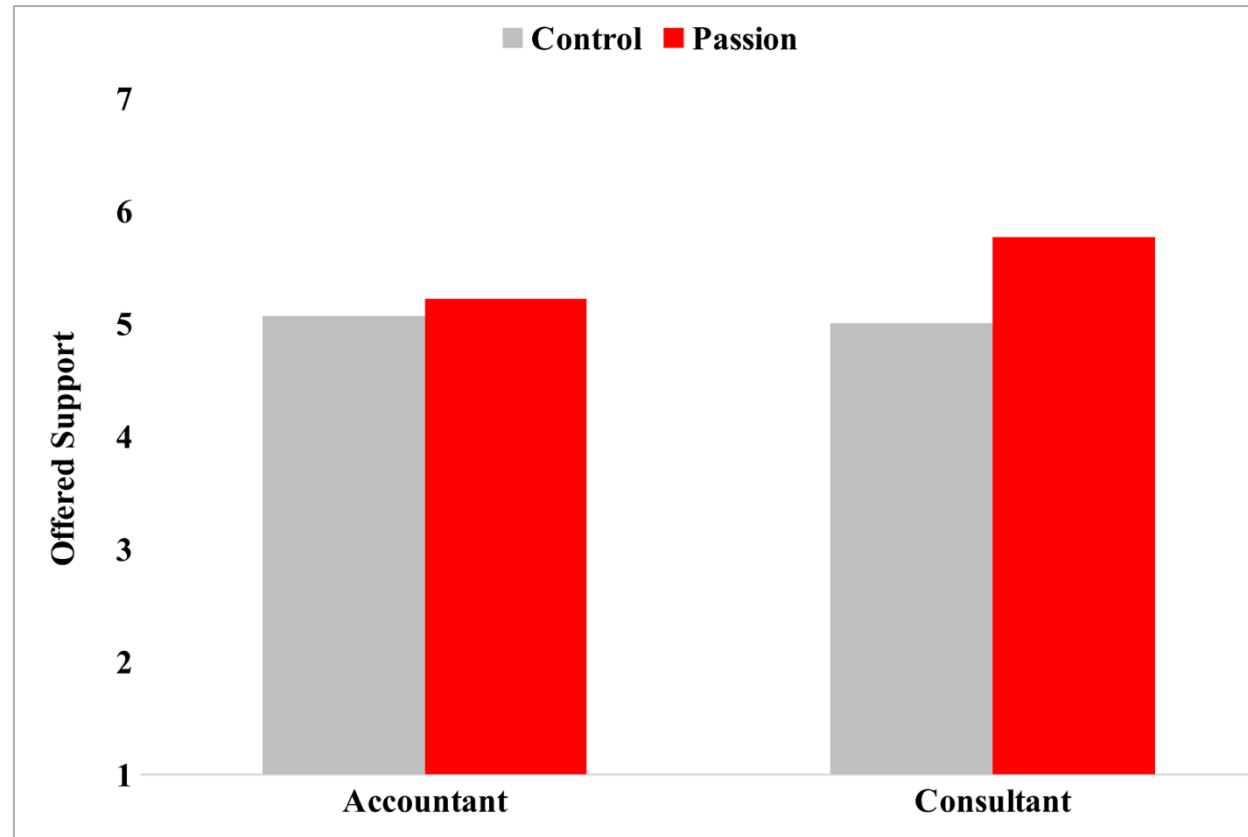




Motivation as a Signal

- Motivation isn't just a private experience — it's a *signal*
- Observers constantly infer:
 - What motivates you
 - What kind of person you are? (Perceived motivation affects one's perceived ethics, morality, character etc)

People Fantasize Intrinsic Motivation and Passion!



Passion helps but the context matters too

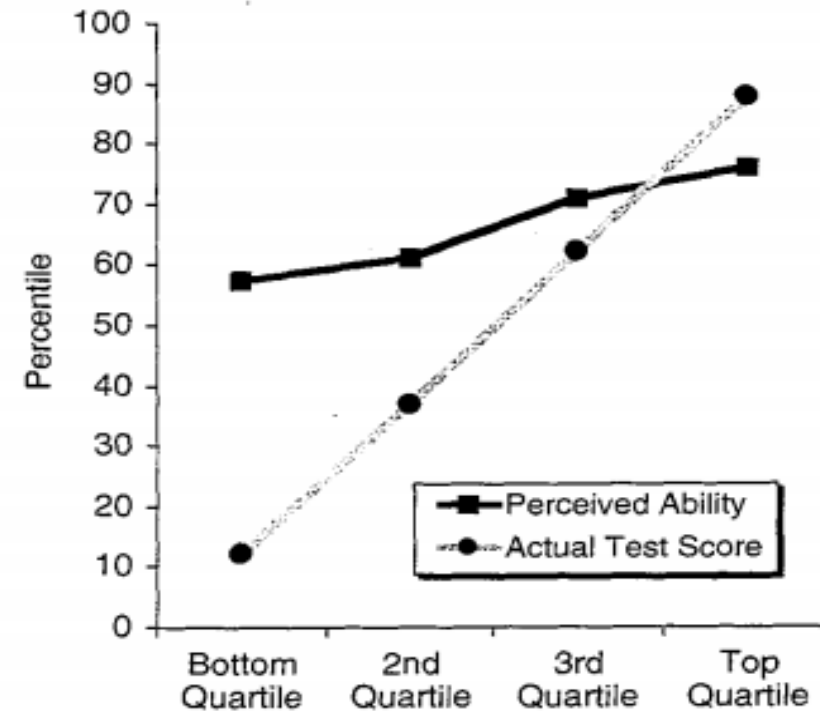
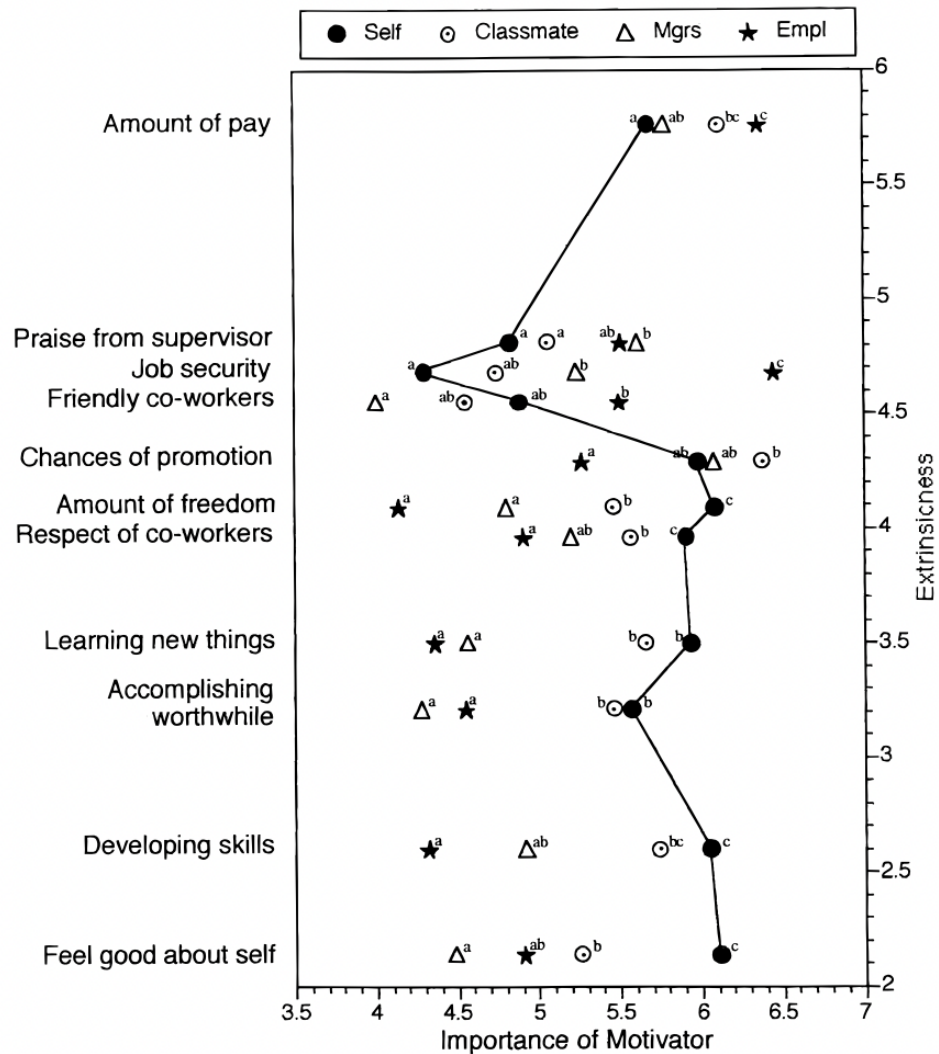


Moralization of Intrinsic Motivation

- People moralize intrinsic motivation and treat it as a moral virtue
- Employees prefer, support, and help those who seem intrinsically motivated
- Employees withdraw help from those who appear extrinsically motivated



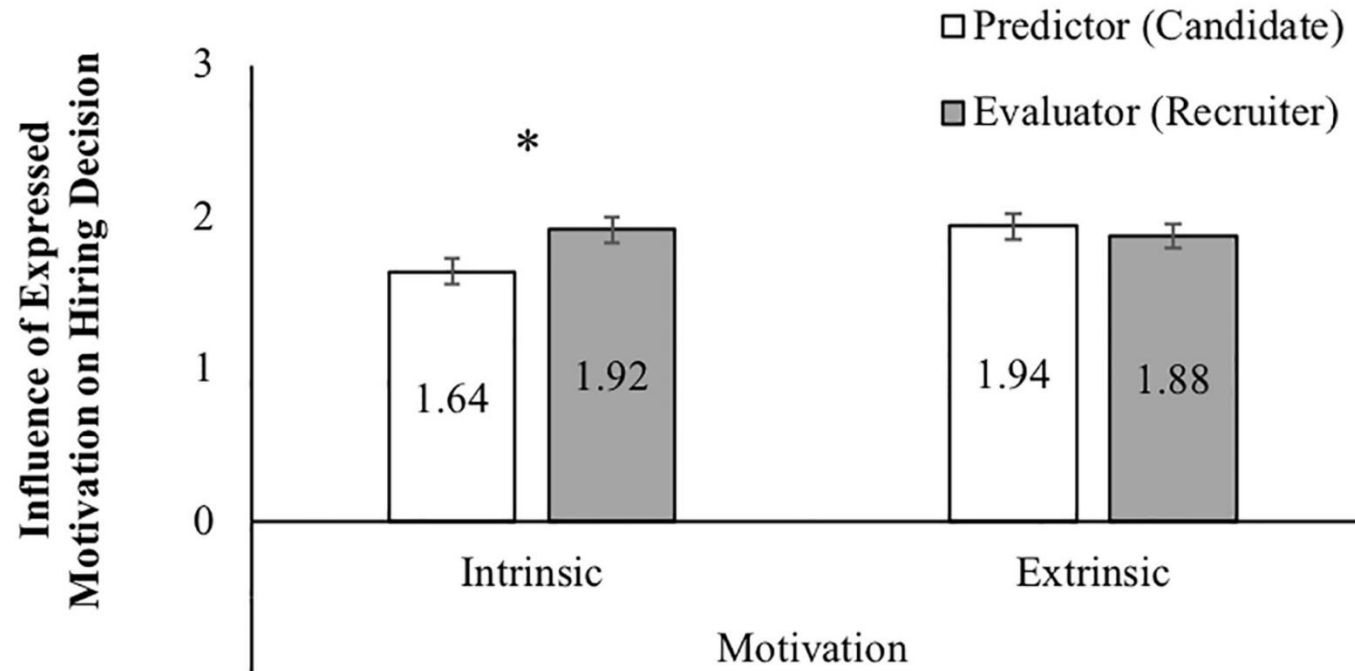
Extrinsic Motivation Bias



Outcomes = Humor,
grammar, logic, IQ, etc.
(Kruger & Dunning, 1999)

It's a human tendency to think ourselves as better people

Are People Aware of These Biases?



Job candidates underestimate the importance of expressing intrinsic motivation during job interviews!

Are People Aware of These Biases?

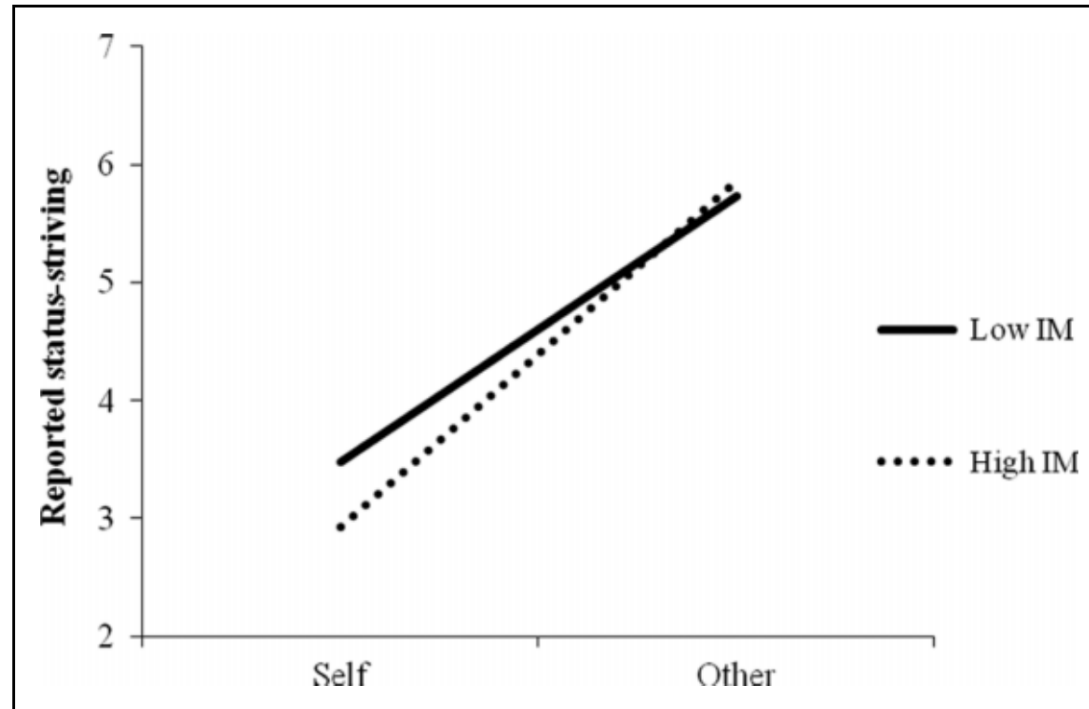
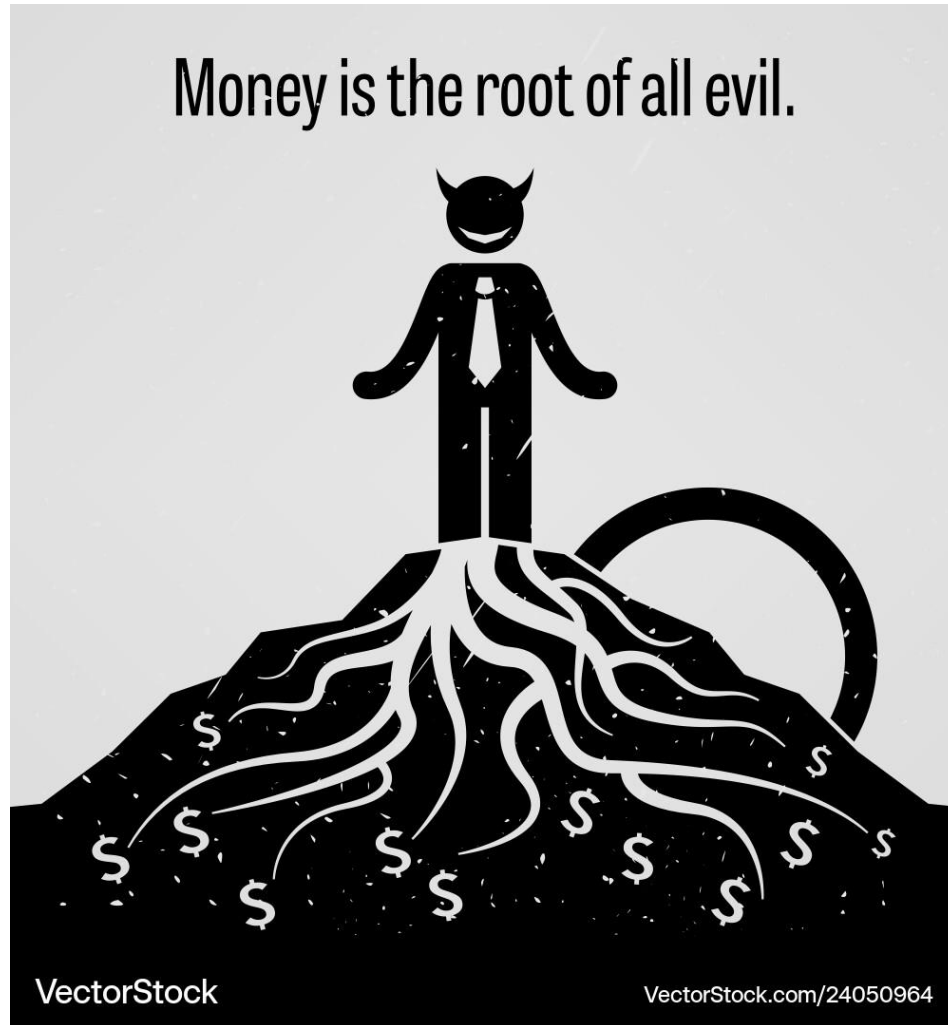


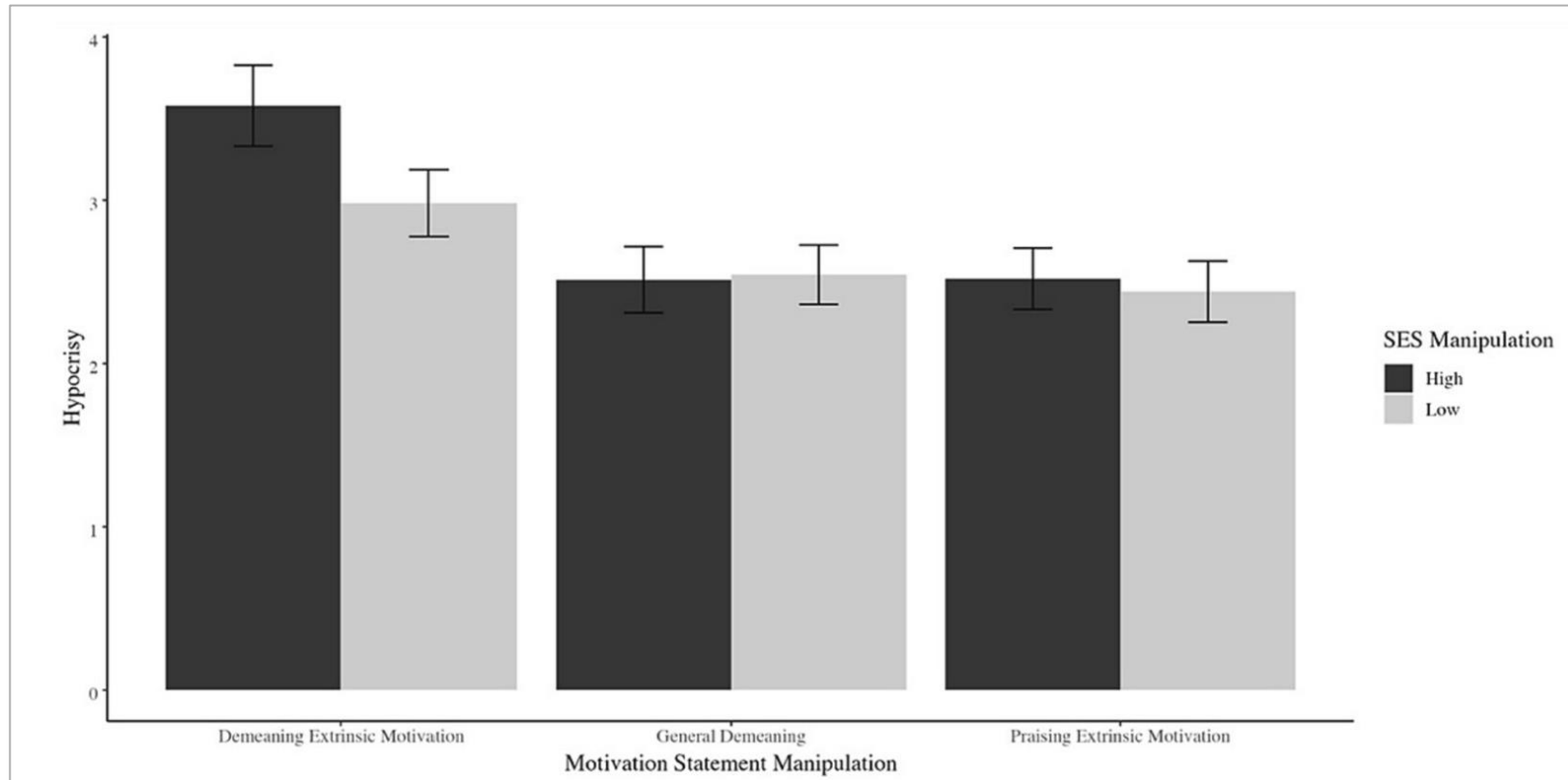
Figure 1. Self versus other status-striving depending on the level of IM concerns in Study 5. IM = impression management.

People who have high impression management concerns tend to hide their EM from others!

What about Demeaning Extrinsic Motivation?

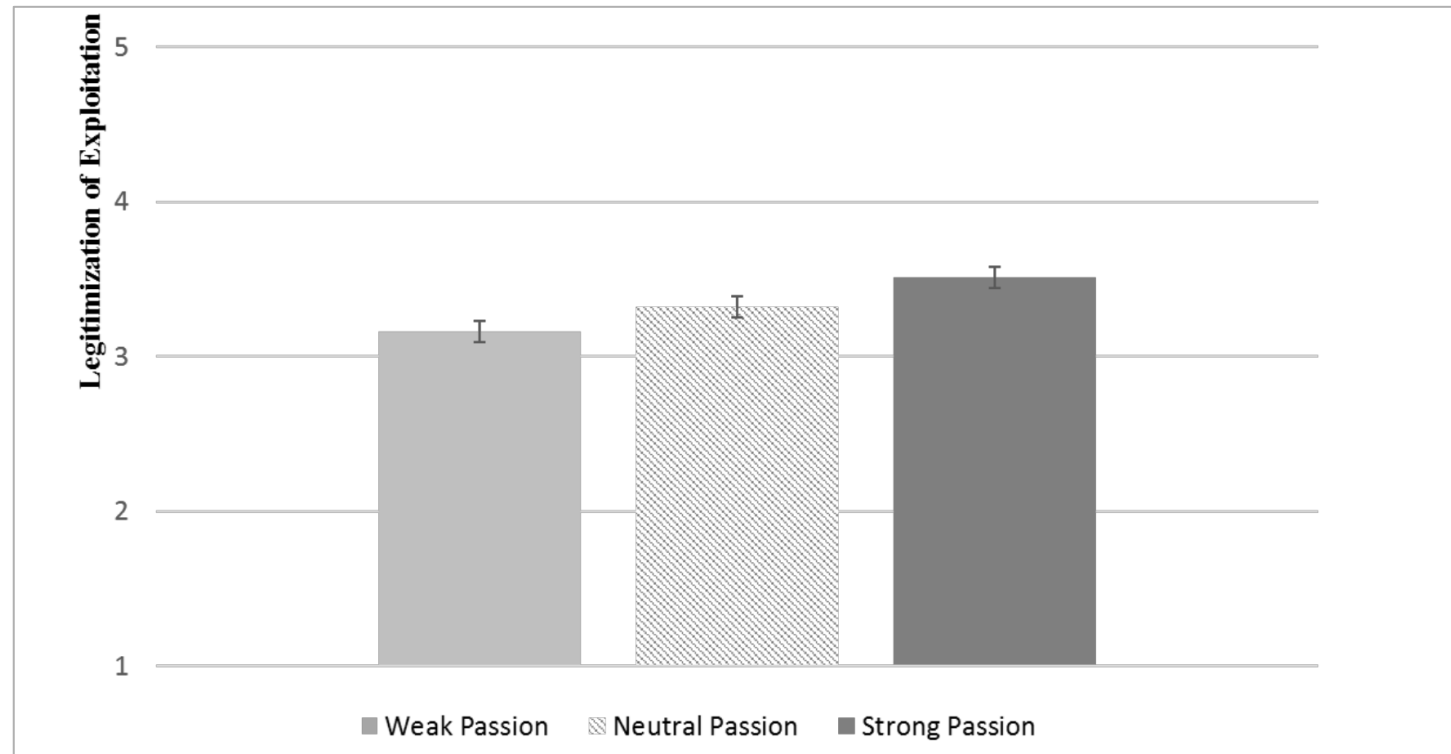


What about Demeaning Extrinsic Motivation?



Demeaning extrinsic motivation makes you appear hypocritical, especially when you are rich!

Passion Leads to Exploitation?



Passionate employees face a higher likelihood of being exploited



Unintended Impact on Motivation

- As a leader, be aware that your words and actions have an impact!
- Whether you expect someone to succeed or fail
 - Subordinates often live up to those expectations



Pygmalion Effect

- When leaders expect more from followers:
 - They give more opportunities, attention, and support
 - Followers feel trusted and motivated
 - Performance improves

Golem Effect



- Low expectations can lead to:
 - Fewer opportunities
 - Less support and trust
 - **Demotivation** and self-doubt

There's always gotta
be a scapegoat...



so why not me?

总有人要当废物



那为什么不能是我呢

Golem Effect (Stereotype Threat)

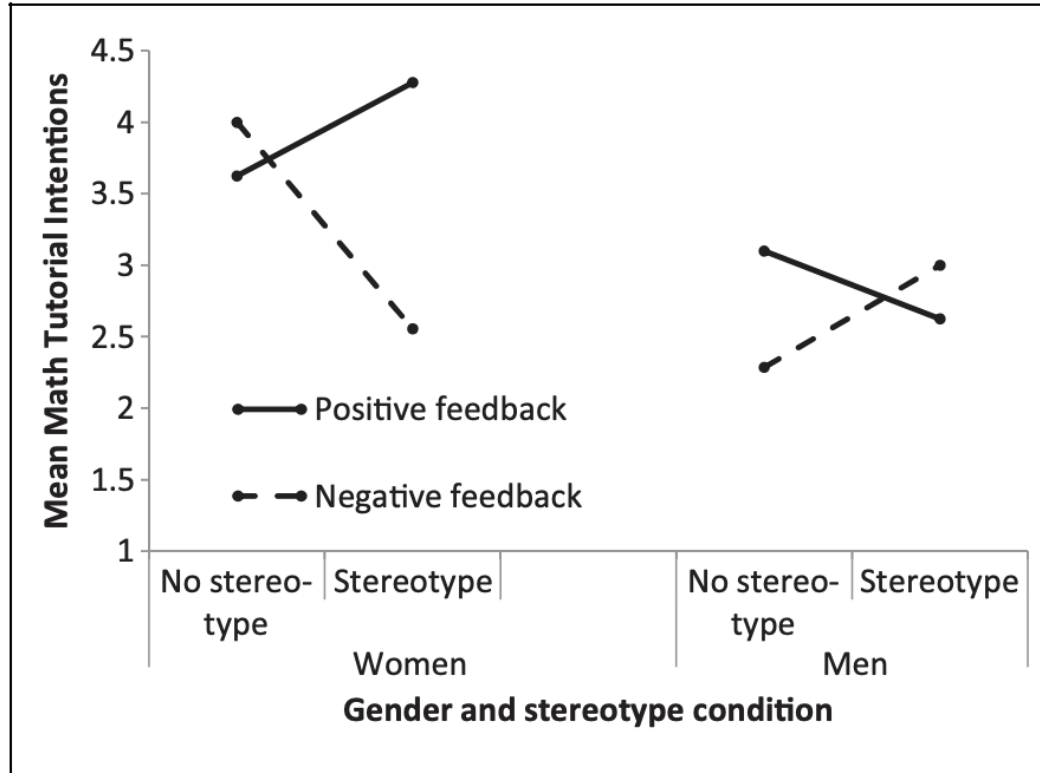
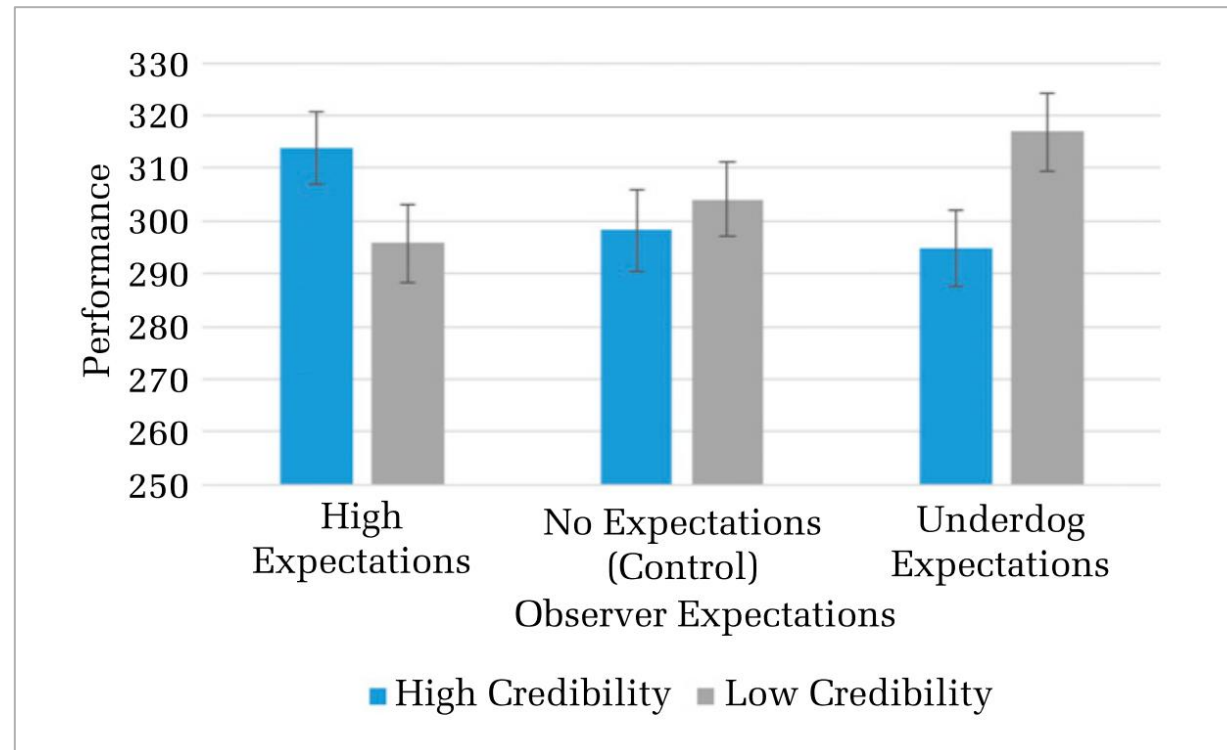


Figure 3. Mean intention to attend math tutorials as a function of gender, stereotype condition, and feedback valence.

Negative expectations create a self-fulfilling prophecy

Underdog Effect



Low expectations may improve motivation and performance when they are seen as not credible!

Underdog Effect

- Some people respond to **low expectations** by trying *harder*:
 - Driven to **prove others wrong**
 - Motivated by injustice or a desire to overcome



Niu Gou (2020)



Unintended Impact on Motivation

- But still, as a leader, be aware that your words and actions have an impact!
- Whether you expect someone to succeed or fail
 - Subordinates often live up to those expectations.